war could turn nuclear." India would not mount a large-scale conventional attack even in response to direct Pakistani provocations in Kashmir. "Irrespective of the presence of troops and the threat of war, India could not have launched a conventional war" against a nuclear-armed Pakistan. To do so would have been "suicide."[20]

Pakistani strategic analysts agree with this view. According to the Islamabad Institute of Strategic Studies' Shireen Mazari, for example, in a nuclear environment "each side knows it cannot cross a particular threshold." Thus "limited warfare in Kashmir becomes a viable option. At the very least, more material assistance can be given to the Kashmiri freedom fighters while Pakistan waits for the Indians to eventually come to the table for talks on Kashmir."[21] Even proliferation optimists admit that the Pakistanis' emerging nuclear capacity enabled them to adopt a more activist policy in Kashmir. Ganguly, for example, acknowledges that one of the "compelling reasons" why the Pakistani military was "emboldened . . . to aid the insurgency in Kashmir" in the late 1980s was that "they believed that their incipient nuclear capabilities had effectively neutralized whatever conventional military advantages India possessed."[22]

Pakistan's aggressive new policy in Kashmir led almost immediately to increased Indo-Pakistani tension. This was first demonstrated in a major militarized dispute that became known as the 1990 crisis.

THE 1990 CRISIS

The 1990 crisis arose primarily out of an Indian attempt to intimidate Pakistan and coerce it into ceasing its support for the Kashmir insurgency.[23] When the Kashmir insurgency erupted, India began augmenting its security forces in Kashmir and Punjab with regular-army infantry units, in hopes of stemming militant infiltrations from Pakistan and Azad Kashmir into Indian territory. In response, Pakistan deployed armored units into positions facing Indian Punjab and Rajasthan, and across the border from the road connecting Jammu to Punjab. In addition, forces from Pakistan's December